

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 6: THE SOLDIER (BY RUPERT BROOKE)

CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"The Soldier" is a beautiful, patriotic war sonnet composed by Rupert Brooke. The poet expresses his deep love and gratitude for his motherland, England. He believes that if he dies fighting in a foreign country, that specific corner of the earth will belong to England forever.

12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. What kind of poem is "The Soldier"? Explain its structure.

Ans: "The Soldier" is a patriotic war sonnet. It consists of fourteen lines, divided into an Octave (first eight lines) and a Sestet (last six lines).

Q2. What does the poet mean by "some corner of a foreign field that is forever England"?

Ans: The poet means that if he dies on foreign soil during the war, his body will be buried there. Since his body is made of English dust, that grave will become England's permanent territory.

Q3. How does the poet express his deep gratitude to England?

Ans: The poet expresses gratitude by stating that England gave him birth, shaped his character, gave him consciousness, her flowers to love, her paths to roam, and her clean air to breathe.

Q4. What does the phrase "a richer dust concealed" signify in the poem?

Ans: It signifies the body of the English soldier. The poet considers his body to be "richer dust" because it was nurtured, shaped, and blessed by the rich culture of England.

Q5. How does the poet describe his thoughts after death?

Ans: The poet describes that after death, all the evil thoughts of his heart will be washed away, and his soul will become a pulse in the eternal mind of God, reflecting back the thoughts of England.

Q6. What memories of England will the poet's soul cherish forever?

Ans: His soul will cherish the sights and sounds of his country, her beautiful days, dreams happy as her day, and laughter shared with gentle English friends.

Q7. Why is Rupert Brooke called a "War Poet"?



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

Ans: He is called a war poet because he wrote deeply patriotic poems during the initial phase of the First World War, inspiring youth to fight for their nation with dignity.

Q8. Does the poem look at war with a sense of terror or a sense of honor?

Ans: The poem looks at war with a profound sense of honor, duty, and romantic patriotism, completely bypassing the real horrors, blood, and cruelty of the battlefield.

Q9. What are the natural elements of England mentioned in the first eight lines?

Ans: The natural elements mentioned are the fertile soil (dust), beautiful flowers, fresh rivers to wash him, and the warm sun of home to bless him.

Q10. What does the poet mean by "hearts at peace, under an English heaven"?

Ans: It means that after sacrificing his life for his motherland, the soldier's soul will find ultimate peace and salvation in a paradise that feels exactly like England.

Q11. Who was Rupert Brooke, and how did he die?

Ans: Rupert Brooke was a handsome English poet who served in the Royal Navy. He tragically died of blood poisoning (septicaemia) in 1915 on his way to a military campaign.

Q12. What is the central theme of "The Soldier"?

Ans: The central theme is intense patriotism, absolute devotion to the motherland, and the belief that sacrificing one's life for the country is the highest honor.

 35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'The Soldier' is a highly celebrated poem composed by: (A) John Keats (B) Rupert Brooke (C) T.S. Eliot (D) Walt Whitman
2. Rupert Brooke is famously categorized as a _____ poet.: (A) Romantic (B) War (C) Metaphysical (D) Nature
3. Rupert Brooke was born in 1887 and passed away early in the year: (A) 1914 (B) 1915 (C) 1939 (D) 1945
4. The famous poet W.B. Yeats described Rupert Brooke as the handsomest young man in: (A) America (B) England / Britain (C) France (D) Ireland
5. Rupert Brooke died of blood poisoning (septicaemia) on his way to the battlefield of: (A) Paris (B) Gallipoli / Skyros (C) Berlin (D) Waterloo
6. 'The Soldier' is structurally a fourteen-line poem known as a: (A) Sonnet (B) Ode (C) Ballad (D) Elegy
7. A traditional sonnet is divided into two parts: the Octave (8 lines) and the: (A) Sestet (6 lines) (B) Couplet (2 lines) (C) Quatrain (4 lines) (D) Epic
8. "If I should die, think only this of _____ .": (A) you (B) me (C) them (D) country



CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

9. The poet speaks about a corner of a _____ field that will forever belong to England.: (A) local (B) foreign (C) green (D) big
10. "There shall be in that earth a richer _____ concealed;": (A) gold (B) dust (C) water (D) stone
11. The dust (body) mentioned in the poem was given birth and shaped by: (A) France (B) England (C) America (D) Germany
12. England gave her citizen flowers to love and her _____ to roam.: (A) cars (B) ways / paths (C) rivers (D) mountains
13. The soldier was washed by his country's rivers and blessed by suns of: (A) night (B) home (C) foreign lands (D) winter
14. "A pulse in the _____ mind, no less...": (A) human (B) eternal (C) temporary (D) small
15. The pulse in the eternal mind gives back the thoughts given by: (A) friends (B) England (C) enemies (D) nature
16. The poet imagines his soul enjoying sights, sounds, and dreams happy as her: (A) night (B) day (C) life (D) song
17. The soldier remembers the laughter learnt of gentle: (A) teachers (B) friends (C) kings (D) soldiers
18. At the end of the poem, the poet visualizes hearts at peace under an English: (A) mountain (B) heaven (C) tree (D) river
19. The poem 'The Soldier' is full of intense nationalistic: (A) hatred (B) patriotism / love (C) jealousy (D) anxiety
20. Rupert Brooke wrote a collection of five war sonnets, of which 'The Soldier' is the: (A) first (B) last / finest (C) worst (D) third
21. The poem completely avoids describing the real _____ of actual war.: (A) pride (B) horrors / blood (C) weapons (D) uniform
22. The word 'dust' is used metaphorically by the poet to represent the human: (A) mind (B) body / mortal remains (C) money (D) house
23. The octave of a sonnet presents a problem or idea, while the sestet offers a: (A) question (B) resolution / conclusion (C) joke (D) debate
24. Rupert Brooke's poetry inspired thousands of young men to join the army during: (A) World War I (B) World War II (C) French Revolution (D) Civil War
25. "Her sights and sounds; dreams happy as her day;" contains the repetition of: (A) France (B) Her / England (C) War (D) Money
26. The poet considers his homeland to be a type of nurturing: (A) enemy (B) mother (C) factory (D) school
27. The line "blest by suns of home" reflects the poet's warm memory of his: (A) business (B) childhood / country (C) weapons (D) school days
28. The vocabulary of the poem creates an image of England as a beautiful: (A) desert (B) paradise /



CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

garden (C) machine (D) battleground

29. The phrase "English heaven" implies that paradise itself must look like: (A) America (B) England (C) Greece (D) Italy

30. The rhyme scheme of the first eight lines (octave) of this poem is: (A) AABBCDD (B) ABABCD (C) ABBAABBA (D) ABCABCAB

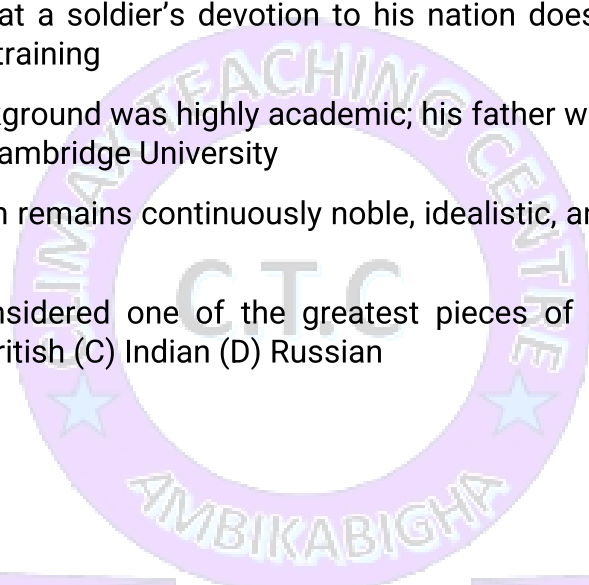
31. The term 'concealed' in the first stanza means to be hidden or: (A) seen (B) buried / enclosed (C) thrown (D) sold

32. The poem shows that a soldier's devotion to his nation does not end even after: (A) victory (B) death (C) retirement (D) training

33. Rupert Brooke's background was highly academic; his father was a master at: (A) Oxford (B) Rugby School (C) Harvard (D) Cambridge University

34. The tone of the poem remains continuously noble, idealistic, and: (A) cynical (B) dignified / solemn (C) humorous (D) scary

35. "The Soldier" is considered one of the greatest pieces of 20th-century _____ literature.: (A) American (B) English / British (C) Indian (D) Russian



SUJIT KUMAR

